Brother Money - Income-Aware Funding Specification

Purpose

Income-Aware Funding enhances the Protection Engine by making it aware of **expected future income**.

It does not allow future income to be spent.

It only adjusts:

- urgency of bills
- timing of protection
- user messaging
- confidence in Safe Spend

The system still treats **current cash as the only real money**.

Core Principle

> Future income can influence interpretation.
> It can never become protected money.

Only money that exists in the Cash Snapshot can be protected.

Problem This Solves

Without income awareness:

- Users appear “unsafe” right before payday
- Apps over-restrict spending
- Bills look more urgent than they actually are
- Advice feels disconnected from reality

With income awareness:

- The app understands cash flow timing
- Bills are contextualized
- Guidance feels human and accurate

Key Concept

The system introduces two layers:

1. Current Money (REAL)

- Cash Snapshot
- Transactions reflected in cash

This is the only source of truth for spending.

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2. Expected Money (FORECASTED)

- Salary
- Freelance income
- recurring deposits
- irregular income

Used only for:

- urgency adjustment
- messaging
- confidence scoring

Data Model

Income Source

```
type IncomeSource = {
  id: string;

  name: string;

  amount: number;

  frequency:
    | "weekly"
    | "biweekly"
    | "monthly"
    | "irregular";

  nextExpectedDate: string;
```

```
  reliabilityScore: number; // 0–100

  active: boolean;
};
```

Reliability Score

Represents how predictable the income is.

Examples:

- Salary: 90–100
- Freelance clients: 50–80
- One-off payments: 10–40

This affects confidence only.

It does not increase Safe Spend.

Income Awareness Logic

The engine evaluates whether upcoming income arrives **before obligations become due**.

Example

Current Cash

```
$100
```

Income

```
Salary

$1200
```

```
Arrives:
June 25
```

Bill

```
Rent

$300

Due:
June 30
```

Coverage Evaluation

Step 1: Timeline Check

If:

```
Income Date < Bill Due Date
```

Then income is considered **relevant for coverage**.

Step 2: Coverage Classification

Each bill is classified as:

Covered

Expected income + current cash is sufficient.

Partially Covered

Income helps but is not guaranteed to fully cover.

Uncovered

Even with income, shortfall remains.

Important Rule

Expected income is NEVER added to Cash.

It only modifies interpretation.

Protection Engine Interaction

Income-aware logic modifies:

- urgency weighting
- bill prioritization
- messaging tone
- confidence level

It does NOT modify:

- Safe Spend formula
- Cash Snapshot value
- protected amounts

Urgency Adjustment Model

Bills are weighted differently based on proximity to income.

High Urgency

No income before due date.

Example:

```
Phone Bill
Due Tomorrow
No income before due date
```

Result:

- Fully protected immediately

Medium Urgency

Income arrives slightly before due date.

Example:

```
Rent
Due in 5 days
Salary in 3 days
```

Result:

- Lower pressure messaging
- Slightly relaxed emotional tone

Low Urgency

Income arrives well before due date.

Example:

```
Rent
Due in 20 days
Salary in 3 days
```

Result:

- User feels financially stable
- No panic signals

Messaging Engine Changes

Income awareness affects advice tone only.

Without Income Awareness

> Rent is due soon. Spend carefully.

With Income Awareness

> Your salary arrives before rent is due. You’re on track.

Payday Context Feature

The system exposes a simple view:

```
Today Safe Spend

$22
```

```
After Payday (in 3 days)

$347
```

This is not a forecast dashboard.

It is a **contextual reassurance tool**.

Purchase Decision Enhancement

Example Input

```
Shoes
$100
```

Without Income Awareness

> Not enough safe spend.

With Income Awareness

> Not safe today.
> Safe after payday in 3 days.

Safety Constraints

To prevent financial misuse:

Hard Rule 1

Future income cannot increase Safe Spend.

Hard Rule 2

Future income cannot reduce Emergency Buffer.

Hard Rule 3

Future income cannot override negative Safe Spend.

Confidence System Integration

Income awareness affects confidence scoring.

High Confidence

- Stable salary income
- consistent payday history

Medium Confidence

- semi-regular freelance income

Low Confidence

- irregular or one-off income

Risk Principle

The system assumes:

> Future income may not arrive on time.

Therefore:

- it is never treated as guaranteed
- it is never spent in advance
- it only reduces perceived urgency

System Output Impact

Income-aware Protection Engine still outputs:

- Current Cash
- Protected Bills
- Protected Savings
- Emergency Buffer
- Safe Spend
- Confidence
- Advice

But now also influences:

- Bill urgency level
- Messaging tone
- “After Payday” projections

Product Philosophy

Brother Money remains:

- offline-first
- conservative by default
- non-predictive in spending
- reality-based in decision making

Income awareness improves understanding of timing, not spending power.

Final Rule

Current cash defines what you can do.
Future income defines how worried you should be.